

Intraosseous Care Pathway

Information sheet for the Care,
Maintenance and Removal of IO needles.

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Here**

How to assess the IO site for patency

- If there are no signs of complications or infection, attempt a flush of 5-10mls 0.9% Normal Saline.
- If there is resistance in the line, perform a rapid syringe flush of 5-10 mls 0.9% normal saline. ***(This helps clear the intraosseous marrow and fibrin allowing for effective infusion rates.)***
- Complete flushes minimal of 8 hourly.

What to assess

- Frequent assessment is essential for safe vascular access management.
- Verify placement prior to each infusion.
- Assess for signs of complications- including infiltration/ extravasation.
- Assess flow rates and for any pharmacological effects of infusions.
- Whilst IO needles are in place in the humerus, movement of the affected arm should be minimised- it must not be elevated above the shoulder.
- **Patients must not have an MRI whilst the IO needle is in place.**

Signs of Infiltration/ extravasation

- Inflammation at or near the insertion site.
- Blanching and coolness of the skin around the insertion site.
- Damp or wet dressing.
- Slowed or stopped infusion.
- Burning/ stinging pain.
- Redness, followed by blistering, tissue necrosis and ulceration.

How to remove IO needle

- Remove any extension set and any dressing in situ.
- Attach a 10ml luer-lock syringe to the hub.
- Whilst maintaining axial alignment, twist the syringe and catheter clockwise whilst pulling straight out.
- **Do not rock or bend during removal.**
- Place the needle into a designated sharps container.
- Apply gentle pressure as needed and apply a clean dressing to site.
- There are no activity restrictions after removal
- Document in medical notes; time and date of removal

Intraosseous Monitoring

Please complete on receiving the patient and every hour following this. Until removal of IO. IO must be removed- once IV access is obtained, or within 24 hours.

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	<i>Is your IO needle still required?</i>	<i>Is the IO needle still patent?</i>	<i>Any signs of infiltration/ exrtavasation?</i>	<i>Any signs of infection?</i>	<i>Flush?</i>
On handover					
1 hour					
2 hours					
3 hours					
4 hours					
5 hours					
6 hours					
7 hours					
8 hours					
10 hours					
11 hours					
12 hours					
13 hours					
14 hours					
15 hours					
16 hours					
17 hours					
18 hours					
19 hours					
20 hours					
21 hours					
22 hours					
23 hours					
24 hours	<u>IO needle MUST be removed at 24 hours post insertion</u>				